

TORBEN S. D. JOHANSEN

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ACADEMIC POSITIONS

Assistant Professor University of Southern Denmark	2024–
Visiting Scholar Federal Reserve Bank of Philadelphia	2026–
Associate Researcher University of Cambridge	2026–

EDUCATION

PhD in Economics University of Southern Denmark (Supervisor: Christian Møller Dahl) Research stay at <i>Stanford University</i> during academic fall 2022	2024
MSc in Economics University of Southern Denmark — GPA: 12.0/12.0	2021
BSc in Economics University of Southern Denmark — GPA: 11.6/12.0 Awarded the <i>Deloitte prize for best Bachelor project</i> in Economics and Mathematics-Economics	2018

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

- **Universal Investments in Toddler Health: Learning from a Large Government Trial.** With Jennifer L. Baker, Lise G. Bjerregaard, Christian M. Dahl, Emil N. Sørensen, and Miriam Wüst. *The Economic Journal* (2026).
- **DARE: A large-scale handwritten DATE REcognition system.** With Christian M. Dahl, Emil N. Sørensen, Christian E. Westermann, and Simon Wittrock. *International Journal on Document Analysis and Recognition* (2026).
- **Inflammatory biomarkers as prognostic tools for diabetic retinopathy progression: a prospective study.** With Mette Skov Johansen, Jacob Volmer Stidsen, Aleksander Lühr Hansen, Jens Steen Nielsen, Frederik Nørregaard Pedersen, Jakob Grauslund, Michael Hecht Olsen, Kurt Højlund, and Thomas Bastholm Olesen. *Diabetes Research and Clinical Practice* (2026).
- **Duration and intensity of being breastfed and educational attainment, income and labour force participation: a prospective cohort and sibling study from Denmark.** With Lise G. Bjerregaard, Christian M. Dahl, and Jennifer L. Baker. *Public Health* (2024).
- **Applications of machine learning in tabular document digitisation.** With Christian M. Dahl, Emil N. Sørensen, Christian E. Westermann, and Simon Wittrock. *Historical Methods* (2023).
- **HANA: A HAndwritten NAmE Database for Offline Handwritten Text Recognition.** With Christian M. Dahl, Emil N. Sørensen, and Simon Wittrock. *Explorations in Economic History* (2023).
- **Cohort Profile: The Copenhagen Infant Health Nurse Records (CIHNR) cohort.** With Lise G. Bjerregaard, Miriam Wüst, Thorkild I. A. Sørensen, Christian M. Dahl, and Jennifer L. Baker. *International Journal of Epidemiology* (2023).
- **Low-dose naltrexone for treatment of pain in patients with fibromyalgia: a randomized, double-blind, placebo-controlled, crossover study.** With Kirsten Bsted, Lotte Marie Jensen, Trine Andresen, Grete Tarp, Louise Skovbjerg, Anne Schmedes, Ida Storgaard, Jonna Madsen, Mads Werner, and Anette Bendiksen. *PAIN Reports* (2023).

WORKING PAPERS

- **Group-Level Treatment Effect Heterogeneity in Difference-in-Differences: A Balanced Approach.** With Nora Bearth and Nadja van 't Hoff arXiv preprint 2026 <https://arxiv.org/abs/2606.24785>.
- **How to deal with machine learning bias in economic history.** With Julius Koschnick and Christian Vedel arXiv preprint 2026 <https://arxiv.org/abs/2606.28063>.
- **Breaking the HISCO Barrier: Automatic Occupational Standardization with OccCANINE.** With Christian M. Dahl and Christian Vedel arXiv preprint 2026 <https://arxiv.org/abs/2402.13604>. *R&R at Explorations in Economic History*.
- **Improving Historical Census Transcriptions: A Machine Learning Approach.** With Christian M. Dahl, Sam Il Myoung Hwang, and Munir Squires https://www.dropbox.com/scl/fi/ay275j12rgeru6rsncw9w/DHTS_06302024.pdf?rlkey=rhb0dg7sayoobcqxxm84cdcrb&e=1&st=i25zzn4s&dl=0
- **Optimal Treatment Allocation under Constraints.** arXiv preprint 2024 <https://arxiv.org/abs/2404.18268>.

TALKS AND PRESENTATIONS (SELECTED)

2026 incl. upcoming

- SSHA Conference, Social Science History Association (USA)
- Seminar (invited), Department of Economics, University of Amsterdam (Netherlands)
- Seminar (invited), Department of Economics and Business Economics, Aarhus University (Denmark)
- Seminar (invited), Federal Reserve Bank of Philadelphia, Philadelphia (USA)

2025

- SSHA Conference (invited panel member), Social Science History Association (USA)
- Ministry of Economics visit, University of Southern Denmark (Denmark)
- Seminar (invited), Copenhagen Center for Social Data Science, University of Copenhagen (Denmark)
- Linking Historical Data Sources for Small Populations (Workshop), NBER (USA)

2024

- Danish Digitalization, Data Science and AI Conference (session organizer), D3A (Denmark)
- Department Seminar (invited), Department of Economics, Lund University (Sweden)
- Department Forum on AI (invited), Department of Regional Health Research, University of Southern Denmark (Denmark)

TEACHING AND SUPERVISION

Formal Training & Recognition

Teaching Award from the Faculty of Social Sciences: Awarded the 2026 award for teacher of the year from the Faculty of Social Sciences at the University of Southern Denmark. Completed the *Danish Lecturer Training Programme* in 2025.

Lecturer, University of Southern Denmark

2020–

*Applied Machine Learning**, *Machine Learning for Economics & Finance** (*created the course), *Regression Analysis*, *Statistics*, *Applied Statistics*, and *Historical Perspectives on Current Economics Issues: Big Data and Applications*.

Thesis Supervision

2021–

Supervised/co-supervised 15+ Master's theses and study projects across Economics, Data Science, Mathematics-Economics, Medicine, and Public Health.

Director, Tietgen Talent

2019–2020

High-school talent program.

EXPERIENCE

Data Scientist

2023–2025

Rooftop Analytics, Odense, Denmark

Building architectures for large ML projects; senior role with respect to code; training new staff.

Data Scientist

2019–2020

Rooftop Analytics, Odense, Denmark

Preparation of statistical models, data analysis, and data creation.

OPEN SOURCE & OPEN ACCESS CONTRIBUTIONS

Open-source code: [OccCANINE](#), [DARE](#), [CIHVR](#), [HANA](#), [timmsn](#).

Open databases: [DARE handwritten dates](#), [HANA handwritten names](#), [HISCO codes for Danish Census data](#).

REFeree ACTIVITY

Journal of Health Economics; The Danish Journal of Economics (“Nationaløkonomisk Tidsskrift”); Explorations in Economic History; Applied Economics; Historical Methods; Journal of Affective Disorders; International Conference on Natural Language and Speech Processing; Image and Vision Computing.

DEPARTMENT AND UNIVERSITY SERVICES

- *Policy Event*: Fewer Young, More Elderly (organizer), Department of Economics, University of Southern Denmark (2026)
- Department Council (member), Department of Economics, University of Southern Denmark (2025–)
- *Policy Event*: 150 Years of Women’s University Education in Denmark (1875–2025): Reflections on Progress and Future Challenges (organizer), Department of Economics, University of Southern Denmark (2025)
- Ambassador Group (chair), Faculty of Business & Social Sciences, University of Southern Denmark (2024–)
- Revision of Master’s in Economics Task Force (member), Department of Economics, University of Southern Denmark (2023)
- Educational Task Force (member), Department of Economics, University of Southern Denmark (2022)
- Department Council (member), Department of Business and Economics, University of Southern Denmark (2020–2021)

POPULAR MEDIA

- [Hvordan giver vi børn den bedste start på livet?](#), *JFM Erhverv+* (2024)